

UNITEDHEALTH GROUP

Common Review for JOHNSON,LUCAS AVERY BOYD

Review Date:

February 27, 2022

Review Type:

Common Review

Reviewer Type:

Self Review

Reviewer Name:

JOHNSON,LUCAS AVERY BOYD

Current:		On Review Date:	
Segment:	Optum Technology	Segment:	Optum Technology
Division:	Chief Data Office (CDaO)	Division:	Entrpse Arch, Integr & Pltfrms
Job Title:	Sr Software Engineer	Job Title:	Software Engineer
Grade:	28	Grade:	27
Manager Name:	MOCKUS,MICHAEL J	Manager Name:	MIN,STEVE KYUNG

Performance Summary

	Marginal	Effective	Outstanding	Not Applicable
Business Goals				

Title

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4

5

N/A

Develop skills & Contribute to a high performing team

Description

- Improve written and verbal communication skills around technical knowledge
- Broaden understanding of engineering concepts and industry best practices for platform development, maintenance, and operations
- Build knowledge around our commonly used technologies and platform offerings
- Establishing meaningful connections with team members
- Continue to create and maintain an environment of belonging and collaboration
- Be an ambassador for culture and modernization
- Build a greater understanding of the GKE and GCP as a whole
- Contribute to the design of technical solutions and platform operations

Comments

Looking back on my first full year here at Optum, I can see many areas where I have developed my skills. I spent the first 6 months of 2021 on a Government Programs DoJo team developing a spring boot application that we named "GP Dashboard". The GP Dashboard was a place where teams could go to see how well they were following engineering best practices. The goal behind this project was to drive toward engineering excellence and encourage practices that lead to better code and a more efficient development process. My time on the GPT team gave me a ton of insight into how code should be developed in a professional environment and the different measures that can be taken to ensure excellence in the products we produce.

Technical Skills Learned:

- Java Spring Boot application development
- API creation
- JUnit testing & WireMock
- MySQL

In July I decided to come back to the HCC Data Platforms team for final placement and jumped right back into the world of Kafka. The majority of the work that

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	Marginal	Effective	Outstanding	Not Applicable		
Business Goals						
I have done over the past 6 months was on Azure Kafka. One notable accomplishment is the completion of quarterly image upgrades to ensure security and compliance with Azure standards. I was put in charge of creating new base images and testing them to ensure clusters would be healthy after upgrades. I also created playbooks for other team members to follow when performing image upgrades. The documentation along with the manual upgrade process increased not only me technical knowledge, but also my ability to write in a technical manner that others could understand. I quickly began to start helping on other common Azure operations such as new cluster deployments for customers and disk capacity scale ups. I also spent time creating new dashboards and migrating existing dashboards to both Optum Grafana and our teams new instance of Grafana. These operations helped me build confidence in my ability to do work that is more directly customer facing. In order to free up some tedious engineering time, I automated part of the Azure cluster creation process. Hooking up telemetry for a new cluster in Azure is now done by running a simple bash script and then navigating to PR that is created for you in GitHub. Automation of common tasks helps us deliver what our customers need faster and frees up engineering time to complete other tasks that are less strait forward. I have made it a point in the last year to try to build good relationships with all of my peers as well as those that manage us. I think I could prioritize relationship building more, but I do feel good about this work "family" that we have here!						
Title	1	2	3	4	5	N/A
Ensure stability and availability across all KaaS environments						
Description						
- Improve upon dashboards for clear visibility of platform health - Improve Kafka operations through automation and documentation - documentation surrounding issue fixes in order to minimize customer impact - automate processes in order to free up engineering time - document general/common processes for future use to save time and prevent uncertainty - Contribute to the teams effort of making GCP Kafka generally available by November 1st, 2021 - learn what common operations will be necessary for the team going forward						
Comments						
As mentioned above, I spent quite a bit of time improving, creating, and migrating our Grafana dashboards to ensure our team and the customers we serve could monitor accurate metrics for their Kafka clusters in all environments. These dashboards carry a lot of importance as they trigger our alerts and are the source of data that can tell us what may be wrong in a lot of situations that our customers face. One accomplishment that I am very proud of is getting into both the support and secondary/primary on-call rotations. I feel this has given me great insight into the common operations that our customers use. It has also allowed me to practice more direct customer interaction and troubleshooting steps. With the recent shift to GCP Kafka I have done a ton of learning. I felt comfortable with Azure Kafka and was able to get some automation and documentation in place. GCP has offered a whole new opportunity to learn and grow as an engineer and I am enjoying the new challenge. I look forward to making Kafka in GCP easy to use for all our customers.						

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Needs Improvement	Meets Expectations	Exceeds Expectations
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Evaluation Summary

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I believe that this year was very successful on many fronts. I learned a ton of new technical skills and was able to further develop those that I had already. I feel that I was an active and impactful contributor to the work on both teams that I was on this year. I built wonderful relationships across multiple teams that I will continue to foster. I will continue to seek out more mentors and grow my network. Moving forward I wish to continue learning everything that I can and to become more confident in my abilities as an individual contributor to this team.

Development Focus

Strengths

Growth Mindset

Having a growth mindset is something that I value in and out of the workplace. I think it is very important to be continuously growing as a person and I think that will transfer directly to my growth as an employee at this company.

Being Coachable

When I think of being coachable I think of humility. I don't know all there is to know or even a fraction of it. Being able to lean on more knowledgeable people and coworkers in life is very important to me. I will continue to take feedback both positive and negative and use that to grow as a person and an engineer. I love learning new things in our technological world and what better way to learn than to be coached (formally or informally).

Area For Improvement

Taking Initiative & Risks

I believe this is a skill that I will become better at as my confidence increases. I am at a point in my career where I should start to take more initiative and stretch myself. Pushing myself past my comfort zone will allow me to become better as an engineer.

Understanding the Enterprise

This is an area where I could improve a lot. I often get caught in the day to day tasks and don't spend time looking at the bigger picture. I would also like to spend time familiarizing myself with the other teams within HCC Data Platforms and the cool things they are working on and producing.

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